June: The split between China and the Soviet Union is final. The Soviets withdraw 1,400 experts and technicians from China and cancel 200 projects.

1 October: China and Myanmar sign a border agreement. The border follows the crest of the mountains, i.e., the McMahon Line.

The Chinese begin to move thousands of troops to areas close to the Indian border.

1961

February: Thousands of Chinese troops cross the border into northeastern Myanmar to attack KMT forces ensconced on the other side.

15 October: China and Nepal sign an agreement to construct a highway from Tibet to Kathmandu. The road is officially opened in 1967.

2 November: Indian Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru convenes a meeting in New Delhi and announces his Forward Policy to consolidate the border areas.

December: India takes over Goa and other Portuguese colonies on its west coast.

The Great Leap Forward ends and as many as 45 million people may have died from starvation and other hardships. Mao is blamed for the disaster.

1962

June: Naga rebel leaders meet a Chinese official in Karachi. He promises them help.

October: Chinese troop movements are observed near the McMahon Line. Mao appears to have reasserted power.

19 October: The Chinese begin to bombard Indian positions along the border.

20 October: China launches an all-out attack on Indian positions in NEFA and Ladakh. Tawang falls on the 24th. In the east, Kibihtoo is attacked.

26 October: Nehru appeals for international ‘sympathy and support’.

16 November: The Chinese capture Walong.

19 November: Chinese troops reach Bomdila.

21 November: China declares a unilateral ceasefire and begins to withdraw its troops from the areas that it had occupied.